

The Twelve Names of the Glorious Goddess

Śrīdevīdvādaśanāma · Toh 741 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་གཉིས་མཆོད་བཅ་གཉིས་པ།

Toh 741 in the Kangyur is a short liturgical and devotional text known in Tibetan as "Dpal gyi lha mo'i mtshan bcu gnyis pa," which translates into English as "The Twelve Names of the Glorious Goddess," a title corresponding in Sanskrit to something like "Śrīdevī Dvādaśanāma." It belongs to the general class of dhāraṇī and praise literature within the Kangyur, texts concerned with the recitation of sacred names and the merits thereby obtained. The text is set in the pure land of Sukhāvātī, where the Buddha addresses Avalokiteśvara in the presence of the Great Glorious Goddess, a wrathful protective deity of considerable importance in Tibetan Buddhism, and proceeds to reveal the twelve names by which she is to be known and venerated. Recitation of these names is presented as a powerful practice conferring protection and spiritual benefit upon monks, nuns, laypeople, and all sentient beings alike.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara. Homage to Vajrapāṇi. Homage to the Great Glorious Goddess.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in the world of Sukhāvātī. Then the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side.

Then also the bodhisattva, the great being, the Great Glorious Goddess, went to where the Blessed One was, drew near, prostrated with her head at the feet of the Blessed One, and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One, having looked upon the Great Glorious One, spoke thus to Avalokiteśvara: "Avalokiteśvara, any monk, nun, layman, or laywoman whatsoever, or any sentient being who knows the twelve names of this Great Glorious One, who bears them, reads them, puts them into practice, and recites them — that one, abandoning poverty, shall become supremely wealthy." Thereupon the entire assembly of spirits likewise said, "May it be so!"

The twelve names of the Great Glorious Goddess are as follows: The Auspicious One, the Resplendent One, the Lotus-Garlanded One, the Mistress of Wealth, the White-Robed One, the Greatly Renowned One, the Lotus-Eyed

Sovereign, the Greatly Radiant One, the Active One, the Bestower of Food, the One Endowed with Jewel-Light, and the Supremely Glorious One.

Homage to all the buddhas. Homage to Avalokiteśvara. Homage to the Great Glorious One.

It is as follows: Jini, Ghriṇi — O you who accomplish all needs. Simi simi, nimi nimi — may you dispel all my ignorance. Svāhā!

When the Blessed One had thus spoken, the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara rejoiced in what the Blessed One had declared.

The Twelve Names of the Glorious Goddess.

Translator's Notes

- The title at the opening, rendered "The Twelve Names of the Glorious Goddess," frames the entire text and is also given at the close as a colophon-style marker; both occurrences are integrated naturally into the translation.

The term rendered "spirits" for རྣམ་པར་འཕྲུལ་པ་ (byung po) refers to elemental or nonhuman beings; in later Tibetan usage this term covers a broad class of spirits. The assembly's affirmation "May it be so!" reflects the standard rejoicing formula of such assemblies.

The mantra syllables (Jini, Ghriṇi, Simi simi, Nimi nimi) are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering and are not standard Sanskrit reconstructions; no confident back-formation is possible from the Tibetan spellings alone.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.